



» BADMINTON
INDIA OPEN

THE SHOW GOES ON

Despite a tough loss in the India Open final, Satwik-Chirag **remain focused** in their pursuit of Olympic glory.

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Chirag Shetty wouldn't have liked what he did with the final shot of the India Open badminton tournament. At the end of a flat, fast and furious rally, he whipped a backhand return into the barrier. As soon as the fault occurred, he crumpled to the floor in disappointment. He lay

there for a while before getting up and, along with partner Satwik Rankireddy, sportingly congratulated the winners of the men's doubles tournament — Min Hyuk Kang & Seung Jae Seo, who had won 15-21 21-11 21-18.

It was a disappointing outcome for the capacity crowd at New Delhi's KD Jadhav stadium. While the rest of the Indian challenge had ended in the semifinals — following HS Prannoy's loss to Shi Yuqi in the men's singles — the final saw the stadium filled to the brim.

Everyone was excited at the prospect of witnessing the Indian pair repeat their title run of the 2022 edition, which, due to COVID restrictions, was played in front of empty stands. They cheered even when the Indians trailed 6-11 in the